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CS 210

06/21/2026

The Corner Grocer Item Frequency Tracker is a C++ application developed using object-oriented programming principles. The program's three file structure separates concerns across a class declaration (GrocerTracker.h), method definitions (GrocerTracker.cpp), and a menu driven driver (main.cpp). Purchase frequencies are stored in a `std::map<std::string, int>`, a container that enforces alphabetical key ordering and eliminates the need for manual sorting. At startup, the program automatically generates a `frequency.dat` backup file containing all item counts without user intervention.

The program presents a four-option menu for user interaction. Option 1 accepts a search term and performs a case insensitive string comparison to return the item's purchase count, or a descriptive message if the item is not found. Option 2 prints all items paired with their numeric frequencies in a formatted table. Option 3 renders a text-based histogram in which each asterisk represents one purchase instance. Option 4 exits the program cleanly. Input validation employs `cin.clear()` and `cin.ignore()` to recover from invalid menu entries, and `std::runtime_error` delivers descriptive error messages when file operations fail.